

Durably Sustainability Scan

Methodology summary - claim-risk screening based on EmpCo and EU Forced Labour Regulation lenses

This document explains how the scan identifies sustainability claim-risk signals, how those signals are scored, and how external stakeholder information is used. The scan is an indicative first-pass screening tool. It is not legal advice, not a certification, and not a formal assurance opinion.

1. Purpose and regulatory lenses

The scan reviews company websites or uploaded company documents to identify wording, labels, icons or visual cues that may create a sustainability impression requiring substantiation. The focus is on potentially problematic environmental and social claims, not on every sustainability-related sentence.

Lens	How it is used in the scan
EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825	Used as the main green-claims lens. The scan prioritises generic environmental claims, climate-neutrality or offsetting claims, self-declared sustainability labels, broad absolute wording, future environmental-performance claims, comparative environmental claims and cases where legal compliance is presented as a distinctive sustainability benefit.
EU Forced Labour Regulation / Regulation (EU) 2024/3015	Used for social and supply-chain claim risk. The scan flags wording that may imply products, suppliers or value chains are free from forced labour, or that traceability, due diligence or import/export controls provide assurance beyond what is evidenced.
CSRD / ESRS, OECD Guidelines, UNGPs, ILO and GRI	Used as substantiation and consistency lenses for social, supplier, human-rights, labour, community and customer-related claims. The scan checks whether claims are scoped, evidenced, measurable and balanced.

2. What is retained as a claim signal

The scan does not operate as a simple keyword search. A word is retained only when the surrounding wording appears to make, imply or visually suggest an environmental or social performance claim. Neutral references such as "working with suppliers" or "backing British suppliers" are not retained unless they also imply assurance, compliance, certification, traceability, audits, due diligence, forced-labour controls or full supply-chain coverage.

Retained signal type	Examples of wording or cues	Why it matters
Generic environmental claims	eco-friendly, green choice, sustainable product, conscious collection, planet friendly	These can fall under EmpCo restrictions when the claim is not clearly specified or substantiated on the same medium.
Climate and offsetting claims	carbon neutral, climate neutral, carbon compensated, net zero product, reduced climate impact	Product-level neutrality or reduced-impact claims based on offsetting are high-priority EmpCo risk indicators.
Labels, badges and icons	eco label, green badge, certified sustainable, leaf/planet/recycled icons used as trust marks	Self-declared sustainability labels and visual trust marks can mislead if not based on independent or public-authority schemes.
Absolute or purity wording	100% recyclable, fully biodegradable, zero impact, chemical free, all natural	Absolute wording creates a high evidence burden and can mislead if scope or conditions are missing.
Supplier / sourcing assurance	responsible sourcing, ethical sourcing, audited suppliers, traceable supply chain, all suppliers comply	These may imply a level of supply-chain control, audit quality or compliance that must be evidenced.
Forced-labour assurance	forced-labour free, modern-slavery free, no forced labour, product traceability	These claims require robust traceability, risk assessment, mitigation, remediation and response procedures.

3. Claim source and detected wording

Each retained claim signal is shown with its source and a short exact passage. The objective is to make the finding auditable: the user should see where the claim was found, the exact wording that triggered the finding, the problematic trigger phrase, and why the wording may need substantiation or reformulation.

Field in report	Meaning
Source	The website page, uploaded document or related checked page where the retained wording was found. For websites this is shown as a page/link where available.
Exact retained wording	A short passage around the claim, normally one sentence. The scan avoids mixing long paragraphs with isolated words.
Trigger phrase(s)	The specific wording that made the passage relevant, for example carbon neutral, eco-friendly, responsible sourcing, traceable suppliers or 100% recyclable.
Why it matters	A short explanation of the EmpCo, Forced Labour Regulation or substantiation risk.
Suggested improvement	A practical rewrite principle: specify scope, evidence, method, time period, conditions and limitations.

4. Score calculation

The scan produces three scores: Green score, Social score and Global score. Scores are risk scores, not performance scores. Higher scores indicate higher claim-risk exposure or stronger need for legal, communication or evidence review.

Component	Weighting logic	What increases the score
Claim wording severity	Primary driver	Direct EmpCo blacklist indicators, climate/offsetting claims, labels, absolute wording, forced-labour assurance, supplier assurance and multiple retained material claim signals.
Evidence-gap risk	Important driver	Limited visible substantiation, missing scope, missing methodology, missing dates, missing verification, missing supplier coverage or weak remediation evidence.
Negative external stakeholder context	Context driver	Relevant criticism, allegations, enforcement, litigation, NGO/union/regulator concerns or negative press linked to the same claim area.
Sector and channel sensitivity	Modifier	Consumer-facing communication, high-risk supply chains, fashion, food, retail, energy, chemicals, logistics or other sectors with elevated green/social claim exposure.

The calculation is intentionally conservative. A single isolated wording signal normally creates a limited or medium concern. High or very high scores require a stronger combination of severity, evidence gaps, regulatory relevance and/or retained negative external stakeholder signals. Multiple claim signals can increase the score, but the model avoids overstating a company-wide risk solely because one phrase was detected.

Score band	Interpretation
0-29	Low claim-risk signal. No material problematic claim was retained or only limited wording risk is visible.
30-49	Moderate claim-risk signal. Some wording may need specification, evidence or clearer limits.
50-69	Elevated claim-risk signal. Several claim signals, a direct regulatory indicator or weak substantiation should be reviewed.
70-84	High claim-risk signal. Strong wording risk, evidence gaps and/or negative external stakeholder signals require priority review.
85-100	Very high claim-risk signal. Reserved for multiple severe claim signals with strong external or regulatory context.

5. External stakeholder signals

External public-source signals are used only when they reflect negative external stakeholder perceptions. Company-owned reports, policies, sustainability statements, supplier codes, corporate news, awards, product launches, partnerships and positive or neutral announcements are not shown in this section. They may be useful as evidence sources, but they are not external stakeholder criticism.

Retained	Excluded
Media criticism, regulator action, court cases, investigations, NGO/union concerns, complaints, allegations, fines, sanctions, watchdog findings, negative stakeholder campaigns.	Company websites, sustainability reports, annual reports, ESG policies, supplier policies, codes of conduct, corporate press releases, awards, positive partnerships, brand campaigns and neutral business news.

6. Limits of the scan

The scan is a structured screening and prioritisation tool. It does not determine whether greenwashing or social washing legally occurred. Final assessment requires human review of the complete communication, applicable law, product context, evidence files, claim approval process, language versions and jurisdiction-specific enforcement practice.

The tool is most useful before publication, campaign launch, website update, packaging change, sustainability report publication or supplier-claim reuse. It helps teams identify claim passages that should be specified, evidenced, reformulated or escalated.

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